

ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2009

Question 1 to 15

Read the passage below, it contains black space numbered 1 to 15. For each black space, choose the best alternative from the choices given

I was sitting on a beach one day, _____1____ two children, a boy and a girl, playing _____2____ the sand. They were hard at work, building _____3____ beautiful sand castle by the water's _____4____. It had gates and towers and internal passages. _____5____ when they had nearly finished their _____6____ a big wave came along and knocked it down, reducing it to a heap of _____7____ sand. I expected the children to burst into tears, disappointed by what had happened. _____8____, they ran up the shore away from the water, laughing while _____9____ hands and sat down to build another castle. I realized that they had taught me _____10____ lesson. All the things in our lives, all the complicated structure we _____11____ so much time and energy creating are built on sand. Only our _____12____ with other people endure. Sooner or later, the wave _____13____ come along and knocked down what we _____14____ so hard to build up. _____15____ that happens, only the person who has somebody's hand to hold will be able to laugh

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|-----|------------------|----------------|-----------------|----------------------|
| 1. | A. seeing | B. viewing | C. Watching | D. inspecting |
| 2. | A. On | B. over | C. in | D. about |
| 3. | A. a | B. the | C. some | D. that |
| 4. | A. boundary | B. line | C. end | D. edge |
| 5. | A. Suddenly | B. Just | C. immediately | D. Now |
| 6. | A. project | B. task | C. duty | D. Scheme |
| 7. | D. when | B. wet | C. sticky | D. muddy |
| 8. | A. then | B. yet | C. moreover | D. instead |
| 9. | A. joining | B. holding | C. uniting | D, touching |
| 10. | A. a serious | B. a necessary | C. an important | D. an interesting |
| 11. | A. give | B. have | C. spend | D. use |
| 12. | A. relationships | B. contact | C. unity | D, harmony |
| 13. | A. must | B. may | C. shall | D, will |
| 14. | A. had worked | B. have worked | C. had working | D. have been working |
| 15. | A. if | B. since | C. whenever | D. when |

Use the information below to answer questions 16 to 18

Okeyo, mbura, karani and Jebet were discussing towns in Kenya which they had visited. Okeyo mbura and karani had visited nakuru, Mombasa and Mwingi. Jabet and okeyo had visited Athi River and Mumias . all the children, except Mura, had visited Nyeri. Only Jebet and Okeyo had not been to Wajir where Mbura comes from.

16. Which one of the following has visited most towns?
 - A. Jebet
 - B. Karani
 - C. Mbura
 - D. Okeyo
17. Athi river has been visited by
 - A. Okeyo and jebet
 - B. Okeyo and mbura
 - C. Jebet and karani
 - D. Jebet and mbura
18. Which towns has Mbura visited apart from Wajir?
 - A. Nakuru, Mwingi and Mumias
 - B. Nakuru, athi river and Mombasa
 - C. Nakuru, Mombasa and mwingi
 - D. Nakuru, Mombasa, mumias

For questions 19 to 22, choose the alternative that means the same as the underlined word

19. Nafula quit her job to go to America.
 - A. Abandoned
 - B. Deserted
 - C. Ignore
 - D. Left
20. He has been acquitted of all the charges.

- A. Freed
- B. Forgiven
- C. Discharged
- D. Release

21. The neighbours managed to put out the fire.
 - A. Cool
 - B. Extinguish
 - C. Defeat
 - D. Cover
22. They called off the concert
 - A. Stopped
 - B. Cancelled
 - C. Postponed
 - D. Abandoned

For questions 23 to 25 choose the alternative that best completes the sentence

23. She passed her exams very well, _____.
 - A. Is it
 - B. Did she
 - C. Didn't she
 - D. Isn't it
24. He may not come, but we will get ready in case he _____.
 - A. Will
 - B. Does
 - C. May
 - D. Comes
25. Mwikali is an intelligent pupil, _____ she is a talented singer
 - A. Nevertheless
 - B. Although
 - C. Moreover
 - D. And

Read the passage below and then answer questions 26 to 38

The day before Jennifer bell has made a solemn vow that was going to change her life forever, no one else knew about it yet, but people were going to notice sooner or later. Right then it was a kind of secrets. Grover middle school was a sixth new school in eight years. If you are as shy as she was it was tough to be the new kid all the time. But it was not going to tough anymore because she had read a book called instant ways to instant people. She was starting with lesson number one that day. It said ‘change your whole attitude. Think of yourself as somebody that everyone wants to get to know!’

That was right and she was going to have fun and lots of it! Jennifer, aged twelve- and –a half, had decided to break out of her old, shy nature at last.

Her mother was driving her to school the first day.

” Scared?” she asked.

”No way,” she answered, wondering if she had time to take her mirror out of her purse for one last peek at her hair. She was a little nervous, but she wasn’t going to admit that to her mum

”That is right spirit, her mother said. “ Remember, this may be school, but **you’ve got a head start on the problem this time.**”

Her mother wasn’t thinking about Jennifer’s solemn vow and her book on making friends. Those were secrets and there was no way Jennifer was going to tell her mother, they were personal and who tells secrets to their mother, anyway?

”I know, I know,” she said. “This is the school where you were a pom pom girl and Dad was in the Maths club, and you fell in love in the eighth class.”

Don’t forget your dad was the chairman of the Maths club,” her mother said with a laugh

Jennifer loved to listen to her Mum’s bubbly laugh. In fact. She was decided to imitate it as a part of the new her.

”My mum, the pom pom queen, “Jennifer said, imitating her mum’s laugh. She wondered if it sounded okay, or if it sounded fake. She decided she would have no work on it. “Do you think there is anyone in the school who still remembers you and Dad?”

”Hey, don’t make it sound like we went to school in the Dark Ages! We’re not that old”. Jennifer’s mother stopped in the front of the school to let her out. Then she said, “Blow them away with the Bell family charm, Honey.”

No problem, mum, “Jennifer answered. When she opened the door, a rush of cold air hit her. She then realized that she definitely needed a heavier jackets. The Octobers here were a lot colder than in California, where they had just moved from

” I like your change of attitude, Jennifer, “ Jennifer’s mother said as she leaned over to look at her through the car window. “ What brought it on?”

”I don’t know. Instant maturity, I guess, she said with a grin. “Thanks for the ride, mum. See you later.”

”Do you want me to pick you up after school?”

”No thanks, “she said. “ I’ll walk home.”

Her Mum drove off and Jennifer turned away to start her life as the new her.

(Adapted from Can You Keep a Secret by Elizabeth Van Steanwyk)

26. How many schools had Jennifer attended in the last eight years?
 - A. Eight
 - B. Five
 - C. Twelve
 - D. Six
27. The phrase “ a solemn vow” means a
 - A. Serious promise
 - B. Change for better
 - C. Great step
 - D. Big decision
28. Why did Jennifer find it tough to be the new kid all the time?
 - A. She loved secrets
 - B. She was young
 - C. She was shy
 - D. She would be noticed
29. What was Jennifer’s secrets?
 - A. To change her attitude
 - B. To make friends with everyone
 - C. To practice all lessons
 - D. The special book she had read
30. What in the passage shows that Jennifer was not really open with mum?
 - A. She thought her secrets were too personal
 - B. She didn’t want her mother to pick her up
 - C. Nobody is really open with their mothers
 - D. No one else could know her secrets
31. What word would best replace the word “attitude” in the passage?
 - A. Thoughts.
 - B. Views.
 - C. Feelings.
 - D. Behaviour.
32. The phrase “ you’ve got a head on the start on the problem this time” means
 - A. She already knows how to behave
 - B. Her parents had learnt there
 - C. She had decided to imitate her mother
 - D. She had acquired the right spirit
33. According to the passage it is correct to say that
 - A. Jennifer was more prepared for her new school than before
 - B. Jennifer wanted to be exactly like her Mum
 - C. Jennifer’s Mum got married at a very young age
 - D. Jennifer was going to use the Bell family charm
34. Why was Jennifer’s mum laugh important to Jennifer ?
 - A. It was going to be part of her new self
 - B. It made Jennifer’s mum a queen
 - C. It sounded funny to listen to
 - D. It made Jennifer as important as her mum
35. In your own opinion, why did Jennifer change schools?
 - A. She was too indisciplined to stay in one school
 - B. She wanted to go where she was not known
 - C. Her parents wanted her to be in their old school
 - D. Her parents never stayed in one place for long
36. Jennifer’s mum said they never went to school in the Dark Ages. This implies
 - A. They never liked being thought of as old
 - B. They were not very old
 - C. They were very young
 - D. They were known by everyone in the school
37. Which one of the following best describes Jennifer’s character?
 - A. Shy, disrespectful, determined
 - B. Intelligent, determined, proud
 - C. Shy, determined, cheerful
 - D. Cheerful, proud, disrespect
38. Which of the following best summaries the passage?
 - A. The journey to a new school
 - B. Jennifer the new girl
 - C. Jennifer’s new school
 - D. Jennifer and her mum

Read the passage below and answer questions 39 to 50

Why do we go to school? Why do we strive to get an education? Well, perhaps you say that we spend so much time and resources in the classroom so to acquire skills for which society will be willing to pay. This is enable us to earn a living and eventually improve our standard of living, While it is definitely true that education arms us with the necessary tools to be able to **put bread on our tables**, there are more benefits that come from education.

Education makes you a better person in many ways. It broadens your understanding of various issues that are likely to affect your life. These include health, economic social and political matters. An educated person is able to independently access information on how to live a healthier life. Similarity, the educated person empowered to make sound economic and political decision based on ideas obtained through different channels of information.

Your thinking abilities are also shaped through education. With the rapid development of technology today it is easier to get information. There is always so much information that is often difficult to distinguish between the true and false: the important and the trivial; the relevant and irrelevant. An educated mind is, however, able to critically examine the information and decided what to make of it.

Society too reaps benefit when its individuals are educated. Where would society be without doctors, teachers, engineers, drivers or lawyers? People in different occupation have their roles to play in making society a better place to live. Indeed, many inventions that have improved society have sprung from the minds of educated individuals. A truly educated person is always thinking of how to make society better by introducing more effective and efficient doing things.

What of peace and harmony? When we get educated, we learn about other people and their cultures. This makes us understand and accept them as part of our society. In this way, unnecessary conflict is avoided and we became willing to join hands with others in order to achieve certain goals for the good of us all. Evidently, there is so much to be gained from education. It is therefore not surprising that governments and households put aside **substantial** amounts of their income to spend on books and other support materials, teachers and development of educational facilities.

39. According to the first paragraph, education
 - A. Gives us higher standards of living
 - B. Provides us with our daily food
 - C. Helps us to gain more benefits in life
 - D. Equips us with skills to live better lives
40. How does education enable an individual to live a healthy life?
 - A. There is enough information on healthy living
 - B. One can distinguish between important and trivial things
 - C. One can examine the available information properly
 - D. There is enough money to hospital
41. The expression “ put bread on our tables” implies
 - A. Enjoying life in the society
 - B. Meeting our basic needs
 - C. Providing food for ourselves
 - D. Earning enough money
42. The word “ sound “ as used in the passage means:
 - A. Clear
 - B. Perfect
 - C. Clever
 - D. Informed
43. A sharpened thinking ability enables one to
 - A. Get information more easily
 - B. Get a lot of information
 - C. Choose information wisely
 - D. Decide what to do with information
44. In society, truly educated individuals
 - A. Are more efficient and effective
 - B. Always think of improving society
 - C. Reap benefit from society
 - D. Invent things from their minds
45. Peace and harmony are achieved when we
 - A. Understand and accept others
 - B. Avoid unnecessary conflict
 - C. Achieve certain goals
 - D. Join hands with others
46. which of the following is **not** a result of higher levels o technology according to the third paragraph?
 - A. Our thinking ability is improved
 - B. There is more knowledge available
 - C. Getting information is quite simole
 - D. Selecting information is more challenging
47. The word “ substantial” as used in the passage means
 - A. Large
 - B. Meaningful
 - C. Important
 - D. Reasonable
48. Educated people
 - A. Are always independent
 - B. Are healthier than others
 - C. Understand things more widely
 - D. Make wiser decision
49. From the passage, it is evident that education
 - A. Satisfies our needs
 - B. Is the key to improve life
 - C. Gives us information
 - D. Prevents conflict in the society
50. Which of the following is the best title for the passage ?
 - A. Education and society
 - B. Books and teachers
 - C. Education for better society
 - D. The benefits of Education

